

Andy Yao

Inspiring wonder in worlds virtual and physical

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EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

BSE in Computer Science, Minor in History; GPA: 3.95

May 2026

Coursework: Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Machine Learning, Data Structures, Computer Organization, Web Dev

Status: American Citizen- capable of obtaining security clearance.

RELEVANT SKILLS

C/C++, C#, Java, Python, Java/Typescript, React | Git, Unreal Engine, Unity, Blender, Linux, AWS (EC2, ECS, S3)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Palantir

Washington D.C.

Software Engineer

July 2026- Ongoing

- Initiated and maintain a flagship MR command and control tool, going from 0 to 1 and integrating with several internal Palantir services.

Mira

San Francisco, CA

Software Developer

Jan 2026- May 2026

- Optimized an iOS companion app to 1500+ hardware units, reducing CPU usage by 60% and eliminating recurring hourly crashes during normal operation.
- Implemented several critical systems, such as glasses teleprompter, app tutorial, and search functionality.
- Heavily involved in hiring, refined interview suite while managing technical interviews for several applicants.

Mixel Studios

Ann Arbor, MI

Full-Stack Developer

July 2025- Dec 2025

- Engineered a scalable Janus/WebRTC-based streaming infrastructure capable of supporting 100+ concurrent streams and thousands of simultaneous users.
- Designed and deployed a real-time Unity annotation system featuring a dynamic, node-based drawing architecture.

Orbit Inc.

Boston, MA

Virtual Reality Contractor

Mar 2025 - July 2025

- Built investor-facing demos using Orbit's biotech, including a modded FPV drone and a multiplayer co-op horror game.
- Configured scalable AWS backend: ElastiCache, S3, Lambda for IoT fleet.
- Architected multiprocess biometric data pipeline achieving >100Hz, <30ms latency.

University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

Instructional Assistant for EECS 440

Jan 2024 - Dec 2025

- Taught and evaluated 30+ students building simulation projects in Unity and Unreal Engine.
- Developed multiplayer ASL experience using Meta Building Blocks and Photon backend.

Sandia National Laboratories

Albuquerque, NM

Mission Tech Intern

May 2024 - Mar 2025

- Developed JARVIS, a secure Unity plugin powered by LLM for real-time runtime control via user speech.
- Built function-calling infrastructure, Milvus VectorDB, and speech interfaces; improved plugin access speeds 150-300%.

ACTIVITIES

ChemCreator

Midland, MI

Product Manager, Lead Dev

Feb 2024 - Mar 2025

- Built Unity VR simulation teaching Lewis Structures and VSEPR theory to K12 students.
- Conducted 100+ student deployment in Midland Public Schools.
- Finalist in Michigan Business Challenge; Edtech winner at +Tech Innovation Jam.

Alternate Reality Initiative

University of Michigan

President

Oct 2023 - Jan 2026

- Completed AR consulting projects for Visit Detroit and the Kelsey Museum of Archeology using Unity, Niantic 8thWall
- Secured 25K sponsorship and 50K worth of hardware for a 800 student hackathon
- Collaborated with Meta, Snapchat, Niantic, etc, to organize workshops and events for 500+ students